



LAGOS STATE UNIVERSITY

RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE

LASU-IRB RESEARCH ETHICS APPROVAL APPLICATION FORM

This application form is to be used by **STAFF, STUDENTS (undergraduate and postgraduate) AND OTHER APPLICANTS** to seek research ethics approval for individual research from the Lagos State University Research Ethics Committee (LASU-REC).

A duly completed application form with its supporting documents should be emailed to **the LASU Research Ethics Committee at: lasu-rec@lasu.edu.ng and copy Directorate of Research Management and Innovation at research.directorate@lasu.edu.ng**. Applications must be completed on this form; attachments will not be accepted other than those requested on this form.

Research must NOT begin until approval has been received from the LASU-REC

Section 1: Applicant Details

Applicant Name	
Contact Email	
Faculty/Department/ Course:	
Applicant Status	☐ Staff ☐ Undergraduate student ☐ Postgraduate student ☐ Independent researcher
Origin of Application	☐ Within LASU ☐ Outside LASU but within Nigeria ☐ Outside Nigeria
If outside LASU, please provide: Name and Address of Institutional Affiliation	

Section 2: Project Details

Project Title	
My Projects Reference No. (To be allotted by appropriate Research Ethics Committee)	
Project Funder(s)	
Other Organizations involved (specify, please)	
Has the research proposal been peer reviewed?	☐ Yes By (Name, Institution & Role) _____ ☐ No

Proposed Start / End Date (dd/mm/yyyy)	Start Date	End Date
Research category: Please tick the most appropriate (one only).	☐ Staff Research ☐ Postgraduate Research ☐ Undergraduate Research ☐ Independent Research ☐ Sponsored Research ☐ Others (please, specify)	
Ethical Flag(s)	☐ Animals ☐ Environment ☐ International ☐ Humans (Clinical) ☐ Data ☐ Humans (Non-Clinical)	
Project Supervisor (for Student Research Projects only) (Name and Designation)		
Who is responsible for the overall management of the research? (Name and Designation)		
Who designed the research? (Name and Designation))		
Who is <u>conducting</u> the research? (Name and Designation)		
Is this a fresh application for approval for?	☐ Yes ☐ No	
If no, is this application a re-approval of an existing project?	☐ Yes ☐ No	
If it is an application for re-approval, kindly provide brief details of the previous application		
Project type: Please mark the predominant nature of this project (one only).	☐ Questionnaire / Survey ☐ Experiments ☐ Observational ☐ Data based ☐ Other- define:	

Section 3: Project Outline & Proposed Research methods

Project outline & aims

Briefly describe the aims of this research, the purpose including the anticipated benefits and risks. This description must be in layman language. If any technical terms or discipline-specific phrases are used, these should be explained. Please use no more than 500 words.

Proposed research methods

Please provide an outline, in layman's terms, of the proposed research methods. Specify the location of your research and other details. Present an outline of the method in a step- by-step chronological order, and avoid technical terms as much as possible.

Ensure you describe the key tasks including how data will be collected and used. Please do not exceed 500 words.

Section 4: Human participants in a Non-Clinical Setting

Complete this section only if the project was flagged 'Human Participants in a Non-Clinical Setting' at preliminary review)

Participant Details

Does this research specifically target participants recruited by virtue of being (select and tick as appropriate, please):	☐ Students or staff of this University ☐ Adults (over the age of 18 years and competent to give consent) ☐ Children/legal minors (anyone under the age of 18 years) ☐ Persons incapable of giving informed consent ☐ People from non-English speaking backgrounds ☐ Welfare recipients (e.g. Orphanages, Internally displaced persons) ☐ Prisoner or parolee
Does the study involve recruiting participants through a gatekeeper?	☐ Yes ☐ No

Source and means by which participants are to be recruited:	
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Participant Information (please tick the appropriate box that applies)	YES	NO
Will you inform participants that their participation is voluntary?		
Will you inform participants that they may withdraw from the research at any time and for any reason?	☐	☐
Will you inform participants that their data will be treated with full confidentiality and that, if published, it will not be identifiable as theirs?	☐	☐
Will you provide an information sheet that will include the contact details of the researcher/team?	☐	☐
Will you obtain written consent for participation?	☐	☐
Will you debrief participants at the end of their participation (i.e., give them an explanation of the study and its aims and hypotheses)?	☐	☐
Will you provide participants with written debriefing (i.e., a sheet that they can keep that shows your contact details and explanations of the study)?	☐	☐
If using a questionnaire, will you give participants the option of omitting questions that they do not want to answer?	☐	☐

If an experiment, will you describe the main experimental procedures to participants in advance, so that they are informed about what to expect?	☐	☐
If the research is observational, will you ask participants for their consent to being observed?	☐	☐

Participant consent

Please describe the arrangements you are making to inform participants, before providing consent, of what is involved in participating in your study and the use of any identifiable data, and whether you have any reasons for withholding particular information. Due consideration must be given to the possibility that the provision of financial or other incentives may impair participants’ ability to consent voluntarily. (No more than 300 words)

Participants should be able to provide written consent. Please describe the arrangements you are making for participants to provide their full consent before data collection begins. If you think gaining consent in this way is inappropriate for your project, please explain how consent will be obtained and recorded. (No more than 300 words)

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Please attach a copy of the information to be provided to the participant(s) to enable informed consent. This should include the 'Consent Form' & 'Participant Information Sheet' on appropriately headed paper.

Participant debriefing

It is a researcher's obligation to ensure that all participants are fully informed of the aims and methodology of the project, that they feel respected and appreciated after they leave the study, and that they do not experience significant levels of stress, discomfort, or unease in relation to the research project. Please describe whether, when, and how participants will be debriefed. (No more than 300 words)

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Please attach a copy of any debriefing sheet that you may provide on appropriately headed paper.

Potential risk to participants and risk management procedures

Identify, as far as possible, all potential risks (small and large) to participants (e.g. physical, psychological, etc.) that may be associated with the proposed research. Please explain any risk management procedures that will be put in place and attach any risk assessments or other supporting documents. Please answer as fully as possible. (No more than 300 words)

Section 6: Data

Please attach a copy of your data management plan (if available) or alternatively note where appropriate: whether consent will be sought, how data will be accessed, how participants' confidentiality will be protected, and any other relevant considerations. Information must be provided on the full data lifecycle, from collection to archive.

Section 7: Permissions (Inc. Overseas)

Overseas: For any research conducted outside Nigeria the researcher is responsible for ensuring that local ethical considerations are complied with and that the relevant permissions are sought. If

relevant please complete the table below otherwise move on to the permissions table.

Is the research to be conducted outside country?	☐ Yes ☐ No
If 'Yes' please state the location(s):	
Have the appropriate local ethical considerations been complied with and relevant permissions sought?	☐ Yes (awarded) – Please note in table below ☐ Yes (pending) – Please note in table below ☐ No

Permissions: Please use the table below to record details of licenses or permissions required and / or applied for (e.g. LGA, governing body, *etc.*) along with the reference, status and the date when it was granted.

Awarding Body	Reference Number	Date of Permission	Status (e.g. Granted/Pending)

Section 8: Risk Considerations

Potential risk to researchers and risk management procedures

What are the potential risks to researchers themselves? This may include: personal safety issues, such as those related to lone or out of normal hours working or to visiting participants in their homes; travel arrangements, including overseas travel; and working in unfamiliar environments. Please explain any risk management procedures that will be put in place and attach any risk assessments or other supporting documents. (No more than 300 words)

Please attach a risk assessment or any other appropriate documents as required.

Section 9: Processing Fee

All research ethics approval applications received shall attract charges as processing fee depending on the category of the application.

- a. Undergraduate: ₦2, 000.00
- b. Postgraduate: *Postgraduate Diploma (PGD) and all categories of Masters: ₦10, 000.00
*MPhil/PhD and PhD: ₦15, 000.00
- c. LASU Staff (Research Unrelated to Award of Degree): ₦15, 000.00
- d. Non-LASU Staff within Nigeria: *Personally funded research: ₦10, 000.00
*Nationally funded research: ₦20, 000.00
- e. Internationally funded Research: 1% of Research Grant value

All payments should be made online into dedicated University bank account using the web link:
<https://lasu.edu.ng/epayment>

Section 10: Supporting documentation (please, tick the appropriate box that applies)

Please supply copies of any applicable and documents in support of your answers. Ensure that attached files have appropriate file names.

Document	Attached
Participant consent form	☐
Participant information sheet	☐
Participant debriefing document	☐
Questionnaire(s)	☐
Outline protocol	☐
Project risk assessment	☐
Travel risk assessment	☐
Original ethical assessment (re-approval only)	☐

Data management plan	☐
Peer review evidence (Internal / non funded)	☐
Local permissions / licenses	☐
Evidence of payment of processing fee:	☐
Others (please list)	☐

Section 10: Declaration

I certify that the information contained in this application is accurate. I have attempted to identify the risks that may arise in conducting this research and acknowledge my obligations and the rights of the participants. I confirm that the research will be conducted in line with all University, legal and local ethical standards.

Name of Principal Investigator:

Signature:

Date:

If you have any queries on this form, please contact the LASU Research Ethics Committee at: lasu-rec@lasu.edu.ng and copy Directorate of Research Management and Innovation at research.directorate@lasu.edu.ng

Please email a duly completed Research Ethics Approval Application Form and all the required supporting document as a single PDF file to the contacts provide above

For office use only:

The Research Ethics Committee has considered the ethical aspects of this proposal. The committee recommends that the programme/project be:

☐ Approved with no changes ☐ deferred (for reasons attached) ☐ not approved

☐ Approved with minor changes

Approved with major changes ☐

Name of Concerned Research Ethics Sub-Committee:

Name of Research Ethics Sub-Committee Chairman/Chairperson:

Signature:

Date:

LAGOS STATE UNIVERSITY RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE (LASU-REC) SIGN OFF

Comments on the Originality of the Research.....

Area(s) requiring further action.....

Other observations.....

The Research title.....

.....

..... is

hereby granted/denied ethical clearance.

Reason for Non-approval of ethical clearance

1.

2.

3.

Name of LASU-REC Chairman	
Signature	
Date	